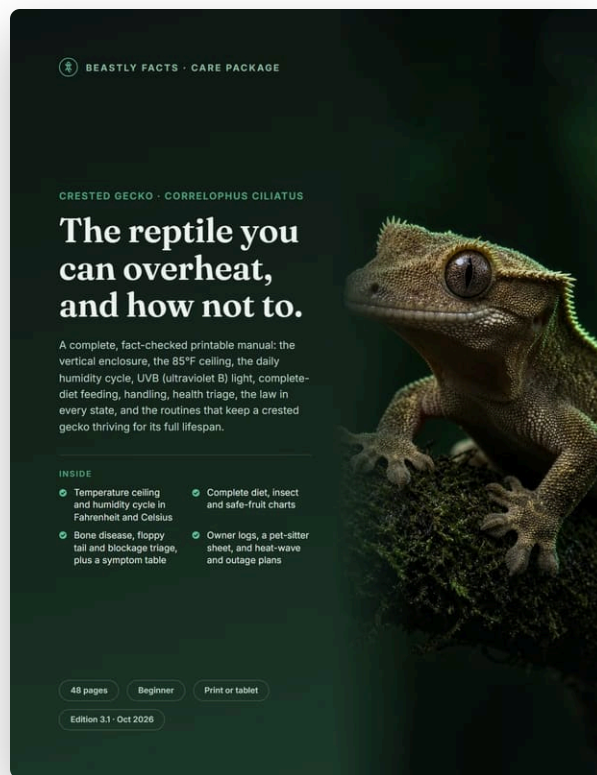


FREE SAMPLE

Crested Gecko Care Package

The first 5 pages of the 48-page printable manual, free to keep.



In this sample: What's inside, How to Use This Package, Quick Profile & Cost Overview, The Species, Morphs, Size & Lifespan. The contents page shows every one of the 48 pages, so you can see exactly what the full package covers before you buy it.

Not in this sample: the 43 pages that follow, which are the full care guide, the health section, the quick reference cards, and the owner tools, checklists and logs.

The full package is \$8.99 at beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/crested-gecko/. One purchase, and every corrected edition is a free re-download from your library. The free crested gecko care guide it was built from is at beastlyfacts.com/guides/crested-gecko/, and stays free.

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Every page is written to be used, not just read once.

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START HERE

How to use this package

Three ways to get value from it, depending on where you are right now.

UNITS USED THROUGHOUT

Every temperature and size is given twice. Temperatures appear in degrees Fahrenheit (°F) with degrees Celsius (°C) beside them. Sizes appear in inches (in) and feet (ft), with centimeters (cm) beside them. A gecko and its weight log are measured in grams (g), the unit a small kitchen scale shows. Humidity is a percentage (%) of the moisture the air could hold. Food portions are in teaspoons (tsp), bulbs in watts (W), the measure of power they draw, and prices in United States dollars.

If you haven't set up yet

Check the law first, on page 25: a crested gecko is legal without a permit in most of the United States, but not everywhere. Then read pages 4 to 11 in order before buying anything. Two decisions shape everything else: how tall the enclosure is, and how you will keep it under 85°F (29°C) in the hottest week of the year. Then use the Budget & Shopping List on page 34 to buy once.

If your gecko is already home

Audit what you have against the Setup Checklist in the print list below, and go to the Red Flags page (page 26) if anything seems off. Read the top-of-enclosure temperature and both daily humidity readings first: most of the health problems in Section 07 trace back to heat, humidity, calcium or substrate.

Print these first

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Page 32: Setup Checklist & Targets | ☐ Page 40: Pet-Sitter Sheet |
| ☐ Page 33: Emergency & Quick Targets Card | ☐ Page 41: Owner Log |
| ☐ Page 37: Symptom Quick Reference | ☐ Page 42: Equipment & Vet Log |
| ☐ Page 38: Daily, Weekly & Seasonal Routine | ☐ Page 43: Enrichment Checklist & Log |

WHY THIS PACKAGE EXISTS

Most reptile advice is about providing enough heat. With a crested gecko the danger runs the other way: a summer afternoon in a sunny room is a bigger risk than a cool night. This package is cross-checked against the sources listed on page 46.

NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR

A reptile-experienced veterinarian. This is a husbandry reference for day-to-day care. Anything urgent or health-related is always a vet call, not a page in this book. Find a reptile vet before you need one and write the number on the emergency card. Nothing on the law page is legal advice either.

SECTION 01 • PROFILE

Quick profile

Everything at a glance before you read the detail.

Scientific name	<i>Correlophus ciliatus</i> , formerly <i>Rhacodactylus ciliatus</i>
Adult size	7 to 9 in (18 to 23 cm) including the tail
Captive lifespan	15 to 20 years, with the earliest known captives living into their 30s
Native range	Southern New Caledonia, in the South Pacific: rainforest canopy and understory
Diet type	Fruit, nectar, pollen and small invertebrates in the wild. In captivity a complete crested gecko diet powder (CGD) is the staple, with insects as a supplement (page 12)
Enclosure minimum (adult)	18×18×24 in (46×46×61 cm), the 24 in as height. Taller is better
Temperature ceiling	85°F (29°C) anywhere in the enclosure. A hard maximum, not a target
Humidity	A daily swing: 80% or higher after the evening mist, 60 to 80% overnight, drying to 45 to 50% by late afternoon
Handling difficulty	Easy once settled, but a dropped tail never grows back (page 18)
Conservation status	Vulnerable on the Red List of the IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature)

Cost overview

Initial setup

\$355 to \$590 for the equipment, plus \$65 to \$210 for the first vet exam and fecal test (a stool check for parasites): \$420 to \$800 before the gecko. Most normal geckos sell for under \$100. Every line is on page 34.

Monthly ongoing

\$40 to \$55 for diet powder, insects, calcium, substrate, electricity, and the yearly vet visit and two UVB tubes a year, averaged.

BUDGET FOR THE WORST CASE TOO

A routine exotic vet visit runs about \$40 to \$70, but advanced imaging for an injury or egg binding can pass \$1,000. Neither is likely if you follow this package, but plan for it.

Fun facts worth knowing

- Thought extinct until 1994, when a private expedition found it again on New Caledonia's Isle of Pines after a tropical cyclone. Every pet crested gecko descends from the few animals exported after that.
- The tail never grows back once dropped, and most wild adults have already lost theirs. Its tip carries the same sticky gripping hairs as the toes.
- One of the few reptiles whose complete nutrition comes out of a jar: a powdered diet mixed with water supplies protein, fruit, calcium and vitamin D3 in one.

The species, morphs, size & lifespan

What you are buying, how big it gets, and how long it stays.

One species, from three forests

The crested gecko is *Correlophus ciliatus*, named for the eyelash-like crests over its eyes. It is endemic to the far south of New Caledonia, in the South Pacific, in three separate populations: one on the Isle of Pines and its islets and two on the main island, Grande Terre. It lives in the lower canopy and understory of rainforest, sleeps through the day in secure spots high in the branches, and comes out at night to move, often by jumping long distances from branch to branch. It is arboreal, a tree-dweller: sticky toe pads let it climb glass easily, and a semi-prehensile tail, one that can grip, helps it hold on.

Older books and some state laws still call it *Rhacodactylus ciliatus*. A 2012 revision of the New Caledonian geckos moved it into its own genus, *Correlophus*, and out of the genus it shared with the gargoyle gecko. The two are close relatives with one difference worth knowing, covered on page 28: a gargoyle gecko grows a dropped tail back, and a crested gecko never does.

Lost and found

The species was considered extinct for much of the twentieth century. In 1994 a private expedition rediscovered it on the Isle of Pines, after a tropical cyclone that year led to a sighting, and a small number of animals were exported for study before New Caledonia stopped issuing permits. Every crested gecko in the pet trade descends from those few founders, bred out through separate lines in Europe and the United States. It breeds readily in a terrarium, so the trade is entirely captive-bred.

Morphs

A morph is a captive-bred line that looks different from the wild type: a different color, pattern or crest. The care in this package is the same for every morph. Most normal and patterned geckos sell for under \$100 and standard morphs top out around \$200, while rare and specialty morphs from established lines run upward of \$1,000.

Size and lifespan

Adult length	7 to 9 in (18 to 23 cm) including the tail. A tailless adult is shorter and otherwise normal.
Growth	Tracked by weight in grams rather than length. Hatchlings stay in a small grow-out enclosure until about 12 to 13 g; males show their sex at 18 to 25 g. The milestones are on page 17.
Captive lifespan	15 to 20 years, and the earliest known captives have lived well into their 30s. Wild lifespan has never been studied.

A DECADES-LONG PET

A gecko bought for a child can still be in the house when that child leaves home. Plan for the whole span: the setup you buy now should be one you are comfortable maintaining for decades, with a reptile vet for every one of those years.